



COOPERATIVE
MINING
slush

getwork
> _

50 BTC

SLUSH POOL

011 / 27 NOV 2010 / BITCOIN / UNCOMMON

ARE YOU INTERESTED IN?

In a dark workshop, three miners connect their computers to one glowing pool. A golden block rises from its centre, lighting their faces, while two trays below collect different amounts of coins. This cavern and its machinery are imagined. The collaboration they stand for began with a public invitation.

On 27 November 2010, Marek Palatinus, known as Slush, posted a proposal for cooperative Bitcoin mining. A small miner using CPUs could work for weeks without finding a block, while faster graphics cards were becoming common. His idea was to let separate computers ask one server for work, so their efforts could contribute to a shared attempt. His post ended with a simple question: “Are you interested in?”

Finding a block would bring a 50 BTC reward in 2010. Pool members would receive portions based on the work they contributed, exchanging the occasional large solo win for smaller, more frequent payments. Pooling did not make an individual computer magically faster. It reduced the uncertainty of when its owner would see a reward. The plan also required miners to trust the pool operator to distribute coins fairly, a tradeoff Slush acknowledged openly.

The November post was the proposal, not a claim that the glowing block was mined that day. Slush Pool began operating in December. The picture captures the idea at its turning point: machines that had worked alone now feeding one effort, while the people behind them look toward a shared result.

HIDDEN IN THE ART

01 THE INVITATION

The pinned “COOPERATIVE MINING” notice carries Slush’s name. It represents his November forum proposal, rather than a historical paper sign.

02 THE WORK REQUEST

“getwork” glows on a terminal. Slush named the client feature that could let separate machines receive work from a pool server.

03 THE BLOCK REWARD

“50 BTC” is fixed to the basin: Bitcoin’s reward for a found block at the time.

04 THE SOLO WAIT

The unconnected computer has an empty tray. It symbolizes the long wait a small solo miner could face, not a guarantee of failure.

05 PROPORTIONAL PORTIONS

Two trays hold different amounts. They stand for rewards according to contributed work, not equal payouts to every participant.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

Slush’s [original forum post](#) preserves the 27 November proposal, the words “Are you interested in?”, the “getwork” explanation, the 50 BTC example, proportional rewards and the need to trust the operator. [Brailins’ pool history](#) dates the operational launch to 16 December 2010. The cavern, anonymous characters, luminous pool, block and coin trays are illustrative metaphors. No item from an earlier or future card is hidden in this version.